

Comparing Two Texts — Part 1

Name: _____

Date: _____

Time: **60 min**

1 · COPY THIS DOWN — NOTES, STRUCTURES & TECHNIQUE

DEFINITION

Comparison questions ask you to find what two texts share **and** where they genuinely differ — in viewpoint, tone, detail, or purpose.

TECHNIQUE — 4 STEPS

1. Find the shared topic both texts discuss
2. Identify each text's viewpoint/tone on that topic separately first
3. State the similarity in one sentence
4. State the difference in one sentence, using each text's own evidence

SENTENCE FRAME TO COPY

"Both texts discuss _____. However, Text A presents it as _____, while Text B presents it as _____, shown by [quote A] compared with [quote B]."

2 · PRACTICE — 4 PASSAGES, 20 QUESTIONS

PAIR A

Text 1: The new cycle lane has cut journey times for commuters and, campaigners say, made the roundabout noticeably safer for everyone.

Text 2: Since the cycle lane went in, local shop owners report a steady drop in passing trade, with parking spaces reduced by nearly a third.

1. What topic do both texts share?

2. What is Text 1's attitude to the cycle lane?

3. What is Text 2's attitude to the cycle lane?

4. Write one sentence stating the similarity between the two texts.

5. Write one sentence, using the sentence frame, stating the key difference.

PAIR B

Text 1: Homework in primary school builds independence and gives parents a window into what their child is learning.

Text 2: Studies suggest homework before age 11 adds stress at home with little measurable benefit to learning.

6. What topic do both texts share?

7. Does Text 1 support or oppose primary-school homework?

8. Does Text 2 support or oppose primary-school homework?

9. Which text uses evidence ("studies suggest") rather than opinion? What effect does this have?

10. Write a full comparison sentence using the sentence frame.

PAIR C

Text 1: The town's new library extension has doubled study space and finally given teenagers somewhere quiet to work after school.

Text 2: Residents living beside the library extension complain of construction noise lasting long after the promised finish date.

11. What topic do both texts share?

12. What aspect of the extension does Text 1 focus on?

13. What aspect does Text 2 focus on?

14. Are these two texts contradicting each other, or focusing on different aspects of the same topic? Explain.

15. Write a full comparison sentence using the sentence frame.

PAIR D

Text 1: Switching the school day to start an hour later has, teachers report, noticeably improved concentration in morning lessons.

Text 2: Parents argue the later start makes before-school childcare far harder to arrange around work.

16. What topic do both texts share?

17. Whose viewpoint does Text 1 represent?

18. Whose viewpoint does Text 2 represent?

19. Why might these two groups see the same change so differently?

20. Write a full comparison sentence using the sentence frame.

Apply this every time: A comparison answer is incomplete with only a similarity or only a difference — always give both, and always support each with its own quote.

MARKING NOTES (FOR THE TUTOR)

1. The cycle lane
2. Positive — safer, faster
3. Negative — less trade/parking
4. Both discuss its effect on the local area
5. Model using frame
6. Primary homework
7. Supports it
8. Opposes it
9. Text 2 — sounds more objective/credible
10. Model using frame
11. The library extension
12. Benefit to students/study space
13. Problem for nearby residents (noise)
14. Different aspects, not a direct contradiction
15. Model using frame
16. Later school start time
17. Teachers/school
18. Parents
19. Different priorities — learning vs logistics
20. Model using frame